ICT Literacy and Competency Development Bureau	COURSE SYLLABUS

COURSE INFORMATION	
Course Title	Digital Productivity Essentials
Total Duration of Recommended Minimum Training Hours (RMTH)	16 hours
Course Type and Modality	Training Course - Face-to-Face, Online-Synchronous or Hybrid
ICT Academy Pillar Alignment	Digital Literacy and Inclusivity - Digital Literacy & Productivity - Beginner Can operate basic digital devices and follow step-by-step instructions in a computer environment
Program Classification	ICT Academy: Digital Workforce
Version	1.0

COURSE OVERVIEW	
Course Description	This course provides foundational digital skills, equipping learners to confidently navigate computer operating systems, browse the internet safely, and apply basic office productivity applications. It introduces essential word processing, spreadsheet management, and presentation design, alongside foundational awareness of everyday Artificial Intelligence (AI) and responsible digital ethics to support everyday administrative tasks and employment opportunities.
Course Objectives	This course aims to: • Provide fundamental knowledge on computer operations, digital hygiene, and internet safety; • Develop practical skills in utilizing vendor-agnostic word processing, spreadsheet, and presentation applications; • Introduce foundational concepts of everyday AI and promote the ethical use of digital tools.

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COURSE OVERVIEW	
Learning Outcomes	At the end of the course, participants should be able to: ● Navigate a desktop environment and manage local files effectively; ● Browse the internet safely while recognizing basic cyber threats and understanding everyday AI concepts; ● Create, format, and prepare professional text documents responsibly; ● Organize data, apply basic formulas, and generate visual charts using spreadsheets; and ● Design and deliver professional, visually engaging multimedia presentations.
Target Participants	General citizens, students, entry-level administrative staff, and individuals from rural or urban areas seeking foundational digital skills to improve employability, handle everyday administrative tasks, or start small businesses. Pre-requisite skills/knowledge: ● Basic functional literacy and numeracy. No prior computer experience is required. Prerequisite competency: ● None. This course serves as the foundational entry point to achieve the Beginner level competency in the Digital Literacy & Productivity domain.

COURSE COMPLETION REQUIREMENTS & GRADING		
Requirement Name	**Percentage**	**Course Requirement Description**
Digital Foundations Quiz	10%	Module 1 A brief assessment testing essential computer terminology, safe browsing habits, basic file management concepts, and awareness of everyday AI applications.
Word Processing Output	30%	Module 2 Participants must create a properly formatted formal business letter or report. The output must demonstrate text formatting, the inclusion of a graphical element, a successful basic mail merge setup, and adherence to digital ethics/plagiarism guidelines.
Spreadsheet Data Output	30%	Module 3 Participants must build a functional budget or inventory tracker. The output must demonstrate proper cell formatting, the accurate use of basic arithmetic functions (SUM, AVERAGE), and the generation of a simple data chart.
Multimedia Presentation Output	30%	Module 4 Participants must design a 5-slide informational presentation. The output must demonstrate consistent slide design, clear text formatting, embedded media, and basic slide transitions.

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DETAILED TOPIC OUTLINE			
Module	**RMTH**	**Instructional Materials**	**Exercises / Assessments**
1. Introduction to Computers and Internet Essentials 1.1. Hardware, Software, and Peopleware 1.2. Desktop & File Management 1.3. Web Browsing & Search Engines 1.4. Internet Safety, Netiquette, & Data Privacy 1.5. Everyday AI: Understanding AI as learning software and identifying common daily use cases	1	• Presentation slides • Standard desktop environment	• Digital Foundations Quiz • File Management Exercise Participants create a specific folder structure on the desktop and practice saving/moving files.
2. Word Processing Fundamentals 2.1. Application Navigation & File Handling 2.2. Text Formatting & Editing Tools 2.3. Working with Tables & Graphical Elements 2.4. Mail Merge Basics 2.5. Page Layout and Printing Setup 2.6. Responsible AI Drafting: Ethical use of generative AI assistants, fact-checking, and plagiarism prevention	4	• Standard word processing application • Sample unformatted text files	• Word Processing Portfolio Submission Guided creation of a structured document requiring layout adjustments, tabular data, and mail merge application.
3. Electronic Spreadsheet Fundamentals 3.1. Application Navigation & Cell Manipulation 3.2. Formatting Worksheets & Data Types 3.3. Basic Formulas (Arithmetic operators) 3.4. Core Functions (SUM, AVERAGE, COUNT, MIN, MAX) 3.5. Cell Referencing Basics 3.6. Worksheet Management 3.7. Generating Basic Charts 3.8. AI-Assisted Data Analysis: Using AI for formula suggestions and trend identification, emphasizing human verification	6	• Standard spreadsheet application • Sample raw data sets	• Spreadsheet Data Lab Participants clean a raw dataset, apply necessary functions to calculate totals/averages, and visualize the result with a chart.

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DETAILED TOPIC OUTLINE			
Module	**RMTH**	**Instructional Materials**	**Exercises / Assessments**
4. Multimedia Presentation Fundamentals 4.1. Presentation Planning & Design Principles 4.2. Application Navigation & Slide Management 4.3. Working with Text & Lists in Slides 4.4. Inserting & Manipulating Graphical Elements 4.5. Applying Animations and Slide Transitions 4.6. Adding Media Clips 4.7. AI in Presentation Design: Leveraging AI for layout suggestions and outlining, emphasizing visual ethics and accuracy	5	● Standard presentation application	● Presentation Build Participants design and present a short deck applying best practices for layout, readability, and visual engagement.
Consistent with DICT's commitment to gender equality, ILCDB courses use teaching methods and assessments that take into account the participants' diverse needs and experiences to ensure everyone has equal opportunities to succeed.			

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ANNEX A. Laboratory Manual

I. Overview	
Course	Digital Productivity Essentials
Proficiency Level	Beginner

This laboratory manual provides the exercises required to fulfill the completion requirements for the Digital Productivity Essentials course. Trainers are encouraged to contextualize the content of the exercises. The time indicated in this manual are the recommended minimum time allocation for exercises within the Recommended Minimum Training Hours (RMTH) of each modules.

Trainers must ensure that the participants have access to a standard operating system, a web browser, an office productivity suite, and a free, accessible Generative AI assistant (e.g., built-in application AI, or web-based tools). Instructors must emphasize that AI is a copilot, not a replacement for human critical thinking. Every AI exercise strictly requires human review, fact-checking, and ethical editing.

II. Content

Lab Exercise	Time	Objectives	Suggested Activity	Minimum Graded Output
1. File Management & Everyday AI	0.5 hours	• Demonstrate local file system hierarchy (creating nested folders). • Execute an internet search, capture information, and save files. • Interact with a generative AI tool to retrieve information.	1.1. Default Scenario: Searching for "Internet Safety Tips." 1.2. Adaptation Idea: If teaching LGU staff, have them search for the official DICT website or local government portal.	Participant must submit/show a master folder containing: • At least two clearly named sub-folders. • One screenshot or downloaded image file properly placed inside a sub-folder. • One text document containing a response generated by an AI assistant (e.g., "List 3 ways AI helps with [Topic chosen by trainer]").

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II. Content				
Lab Exercise	**Time**	**Objectives**	**Suggested Activity**	**Minimum Graded Output**
2. AI-Assisted Word Processing & Mail Merge	3.5 hours	• Draft a document using AI assistance and apply human verification/editing. • Apply fundamental text and page formatting (margins, alignment). • Insert a structured data table. • Execute a functional mail merge.	2.1. Default Scenario: A formal invitation to a digital skills workshop. 2.2. Adaptation Idea: For entrepreneurs, draft a promotional letter to 3 loyal customers. For teachers, draft a parent-teacher meeting notice.	Participant must submit a finalized, merged document file demonstrating: • A multi-paragraph document with evidence of human editing (no raw AI placeholders like "[Insert Name]"). • Applied formatting (e.g., justified text, standard font sizes, 1-inch margins). • An embedded table with at least 2 columns and 3 rows. • Successful execution of a Mail Merge linking to a separate data source, generating at least three distinct, personalized letters in one file.
3. Spreadsheet Tracking & Verification	4 hours	• Input, structure, and format raw tabular data. • Apply basic arithmetic formulas and verify AI-suggested logic. • Calculate totals using core functions (SUM, AVERAGE). • Translate data into a visual chart.	3.1. Default Scenario: Basic office supplies inventory tracker. 3.2. Adaptation Idea: For store owners, track sales over a week. For students, track a monthly personal allowance budget.	Participant must submit a working spreadsheet file demonstrating: • Clearly labeled column headers. • At least one column properly formatted for specific data types (e.g., Currency or Dates). • Working arithmetic formulas (e.g., multiplying Quantity x Price). Values must not be hard-typed; formulas must be visible in the formula bar. • Accurate use of the =SUM() and =AVERAGE() functions. • A generated chart (Pie, Bar, or Line) accurately reflecting the selected data range, complete with a chart title.

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II. Content				
Lab Exercise	**Time**	**Objectives**	**Suggested Activity**	**Minimum Graded Output**
4. Multimedia Presentation & Ethical Design	4 hours	• Organize information sequentially across multiple slides. • Integrate text, bulleted lists, and media (images/charts) cleanly. • Use AI-assisted design tools to improve visual layout, ensuring text accuracy is maintained. • Apply basic presentation mechanics (transitions).	4.1. Default Scenario: "My Digital Skills Journey" – summarizing what was learned in the course. 4.2. Adaptation Idea: A 5-minute pitch for a small community project or a brief presentation of the business inventory created in Lab 3.	Participant must submit a presentation file demonstrating: • A minimum of 5 slides with a consistent theme or background. • Evidence of varied slide layouts (e.g., Title slide, Title & Content slide). • Successful integration of the chart generated in Lab 3 or the image captured in Lab 1. • Visual improvement on at least two slides using the software's built-in AI layout assistant (e.g., Designer, Explore) without distorting the core text. • Functioning slide transitions applied uniformly across the presentation.

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